2.1

Bole So Nihal, Sat Sri Akal

A few months after I had become a Major General, Hira (Lt Gen NPS Hira, PVSM, AVSM, SM, VSM [Retd]) and I were catching up on Regimental matters (he was the Colonel of the Regiment[1] then), when he remarked '*Jadon asi daru peende si, kadi lagya si ki asi jarnail banenge*?' (When we used to sit down to drink [as Young Officers], did we ever imagine that we would be Generals one day?) We shared a hearty laugh as we clinked glasses, but that set me thinking to the day I reported as 2/Lt (Second Lieutenant) MM Naravane to 'Lucky Seven' and the experiences I have had.

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Gangtok

After a two-week orientation period at the Regimental Centre at Fatehgarh, Uttar Pradesh, I reported to the unit at Gangtok, where we were part of 64 Mountain Brigade under 17 Mountain Division in June 1980. Lt Col Madan Das was the then Commanding Officer (CO), a fatherly sort of figure, with a twinkle in his eyes and a handsome moustache. I don't

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